structure. How could they do this? he fumed. Neutron stars were his babies, not theirs; they had no business working on neutron star—sand, besides, although Tolman would talk to him occasionally, Oppenheimer was not consulting him at all!

In the plethora of papers that Zwicky had written about neutron stars, however, there was only talk and speculation, no real details. He had been so busy getting under way a major (and highly successful) observational search for supernovae and giving lectures and writing papers about the idea of a neutron star and its role in supernovae that he had never gotten around to trying to fill in the details. But now his competitive spirit demanded action. Early in 1938 he did his best to develop a detailed mathematical theory of neutron stars and tie it to his supernova observations. His best effort was published in the 15 April 1939 issue of the *Physical Review* under the title "On the Theory and Observation of Highly Collapsed Stars." His paper is two and a half times longer than that of Oppenheimer and Volkoff; it contains not a single reference to the two-months-earlier Oppenheimer–Volkoff article, though it does refer to a subsidiary and minor article by Volkoff alone; and it contains nothing memorable. Indeed, much of it is simply wrong. By contrast, the Oppenheimer–Volkoff paper is a tour de force, elegant, rich in insights, correct in all details.

Despite this, Zwicky is venerated today, more than half a century later, for inventing the concept of a neutron star, for recognizing, correctly, that neutron stars are created in supernova explosions and energize them, for proving observationally, with Baade, that supernovae are indeed a unique class of astronomical objects, for initiating and carrying through a definitive, decades-long observational study of supernovae—and for a variety of other insights unrelated to neutron stars or supernovae.

How is it that a man with so meager an understanding of the laws of physics could have been so prescient? My own opinion is that he embodied a remarkable combination of character traits: enough understanding of theoretical physics to get things right qualitatively, if not quantitatively; so intense a curiosity as to keep up with everything happening in all of physics and astronomy; an ability to discern, intuitively, in a way that few others could, connections between disparate phenomena; and, of not least importance, such great faith in his own inside track to truth that he had no fear whatsoever of making a fool of himself by his speculations. He knew